

Company Vacation Policy

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1. Purpose

This directive establishes a fair and transparent process for earning, requesting, using, and carrying over paid annual vacation. It supports employee well-being, predictable team coverage, and equal access to popular leave periods.

2. Scope

This directive applies to all employees. Entitlement for part-time employees is prorated according to contracted working time. Contractors and agency workers are not covered unless their contract states otherwise.

Statutory leave, collective agreements, and employment contracts take precedence where they provide a different or greater entitlement.

3. Vacation year and entitlement

The vacation year runs from January 1 through December 31.

All full-time employees receive 25 working days of paid annual vacation per year, regardless of length of service. Employees who start or leave during the year receive a prorated entitlement. Vacation accrues monthly and is available from the employee's start date.

In addition, each employee receives two paid personal well-being days per calendar year. These days:

- may be requested on the day they are needed;
- do not require the employee to disclose a reason;
- cannot be carried over or paid out; and
- are separate from annual vacation and sick leave.

Public holidays and other statutory leave are not deducted from annual vacation.

4. Requesting and approving vacation

Vacation must be requested in the HR system and approved before travel or other commitments are made.

- Requests for one to four working days should be submitted at least five calendar days in advance.
- Requests for five to nine working days should be submitted at least 15 calendar days in advance.
- Requests for ten or more working days should be submitted at least 30 calendar days in advance.

Managers must normally approve, decline, or request alternate dates within five working days. A decline must include an operational reason.

For school holidays and year-end periods, managers will consider team coverage, prior-year access, caring responsibilities, and employee preferences rather than using a first-come-first-served rule alone.

5. Planning and disconnection

Employees should submit an outline of their planned vacation by March 31 and are encouraged to take at least one break of ten consecutive working days. Every employee should take at least one break of five consecutive working days unless prevented by protected leave or another exceptional circumstance.

Before leave, employees must arrange a reasonable handover and out-of-office message. Employees are not expected to read messages, attend meetings, or remain routinely available during vacation. Remote work from another location is work and must not be recorded as vacation.

6. Carryover

Up to ten unused vacation days may be carried into the next vacation year with manager approval. Carried days must be used by June 30 and are used before the new year's entitlement.

Additional days may carry over when the employee could not take leave because of certified long-term sickness, protected leave, a documented company requirement, or applicable law. Managers and People Operations must prepare a leave plan when an employee has more than 15 unused days on October 1.

7. Optional vacation purchase

Employees who have completed probation may request to purchase up to five additional vacation days for the following year through the annual benefits enrollment process. Approval depends on team capacity and local payroll rules. The cost is deducted evenly from salary during that vacation year.

Purchased days:

- must be used after statutory and standard company vacation;
- cannot normally be carried over; and
- are refunded through payroll if employment ends before they can be used.

8. Changes and cancellation

Employees may change or cancel approved vacation with manager consent. The company may cancel approved vacation only for a serious and unforeseen business-continuity need, with approval from the business-unit director and People Operations.

The business unit will reimburse reasonable, documented, non-refundable costs directly caused by a company cancellation. A manager may not ask an employee to cancel leave solely because routine work was not reassigned.

9. Sickness during vacation

Vacation days may be converted to sick leave when the employee promptly follows the normal sickness-reporting process and provides evidence required by local law or the Sickness Absence Directive. Converted vacation days are returned to the employee's balance.

10. Pay and termination

Vacation is paid using the employee's normal vacation-pay calculation under local law. The company does not pay cash instead of vacation during employment except where legally required.

On termination, unused accrued vacation is paid or scheduled during the notice period as permitted by law. Personal well-being days are not paid out. Vacation taken beyond the accrued balance may be recovered where legally permitted and authorized.

11. Responsibilities

Employees must keep leave records accurate and provide an appropriate handover. Managers must apply the approval criteria consistently, monitor balances, protect minimum coverage, and support genuine disconnection from work.

People Operations maintains balances, audits approval patterns, and advises on statutory or exceptional cases.

12. Non-compliance and exceptions

Absence without approval or notification may be treated as unauthorized absence. Exceptions require written approval from the People Operations Director and must be recorded in the HR system.